

Fake eyes

Some bugs have eyespots that look like the eyes of bigger animals. Eyespots on bugs such as caterpillars and butterflies confuse and frighten predators and can deter birds and other potential attackers.

Eyespot

Owl butterfly

Pupa

The pupae of owl butterflies blend into their surroundings, helping them stay hidden and out of danger.

Guess who?

For some bugs, just looking dangerous is enough to scare off attackers. Even harmless bugs use this trick to avoid becoming dinner.

Hawk-moth caterpillar

Some hawk-moth caterpillars trick attackers into thinking they are harmful snakes.

Standing out

If you are poisonous, there's no need to hide. Nasty tasting or toxic bugs are often brightly colored to warn predators not to eat them.

Frangipani hornworm